

MoSPI

- Ministry of Statistics and programme Implementation(MoSPI) came into existence as an independent Ministry on 15th October 1999 after the merger of the Department of Statistics and the Department of Programme Implementation. The Ministry has two wings, viz. Statistics Wing, called National Statistical Office (NSO) and Programme Implementation (PI) Wing. The Programme Implementation Wing has two Divisions, namely, (i) Infrastructure and Project Monitoring and (ii) Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme.
- The National Income Committee (1949) appointed by the Government of India noticed several large gaps in the statistical database of the country and recommended measures to bring improvements in the system of data collection. The need for creating a sound statistical system, led to the establishment of the Central Statistical Unit (1949) – later converted into the Central Statistical Organisation (1951) – and the Directorate of the National Sample Survey (1950), the Computer Centre (1967) and the National Sample Survey Organisation (1970).
- Ministry also acts as the nodal Ministry for the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI) and ensures its functioning in accordance with the provisions of the Indian Statistical Institute Act, 1959.
- India is a subscriber to the International Monetary Fund's (IMF) Special Data Dissemination Standards (SDDS) and is currently fulfilling the Standards. The Ministry maintains an 'Advance Release Calendar' for its data categories covered under the SDDS, which is disseminated on the Ministry's website as well as on the Dissemination Standards Bulletin Board (DSBB) of the IMF.

☐ **Statistical System at the Centre**

The collection of statistics for different subject-specific areas, like agriculture, labour, commerce, industry, etc. vests with the corresponding administrative ministries. More often than not, the statistical information is collected as a by-product of administration or for monitoring the progress of specific programmes. Some of the ministries, like Agriculture, Water Resources, Health, etc. have full-fledged statistical divisions, while most others have only a nucleus cell. Large-scale statistical operations like the Population Census, Annual Survey of Industries, Economic Census, etc. are generally centralised, and these cater to the needs of other ministries and departments, as well as State Governments. In important ministries, officers of the Indian Statistical Service (ISS) and subordinate statistical staff perform the statistical functions. The Central Statistical Organisation (CSO) in the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoS&PI) is the nodal agency for a planned development of the statistical system in the country and for bringing about coordination in statistical activities among statistical agencies in the GoI and State DESs.

☐ **Statistical System in the States**

The Statistical System in the States is similar to that at the Centre. It is generally decentralised laterally over the Departments of the State Government, with major Departments, such as, agriculture or health, having large statistical divisions for the work of departmental statistics. At the apex level is the Directorate (formerly Bureau) of Economics and Statistics (DES), which is formally responsible for the coordination of statistical activities in the State. The DESs have large organisations at the headquarters, with statistical offices in the districts and, in some cases, in the regions of the State. The statistical activity of the DESs is more or less uniform. They publish statistical abstracts and handbooks of the States, annual economic reviews or surveys, district statistical abstracts, and State budget analysis; work out the estimates of the State Domestic Product and Retail Price Index Numbers and engage in such other statistical activities as is relevant to the State.

☐ **Main features of the Indian Statistical System can be summarised as:**

- The Administrative Statistics System is its major component
- It is laterally and vertically decentralised
- In it, not only data collection but also compilation, processing and preparation of results are carried out by the States for most of the sectors
- It is the State-wise results, which flow to the Centre, and statistics at the all-India level are obtained as the aggregates of State-level statistics
- The professional statistical work at the Centre and in the States is carried out in a few cases by professional statistical cadres and mostly by non-professionals. This arrangement had its implications on quality of data, standardisation (due to lack of uniform training), credibility and timeliness of statistical products.

☐ **ADMINISTRATIVE STATISTICAL SYSTEM**

The main sources of statistics in India as elsewhere are: (a) Administrative Statistics – generally collected by State Governments; consisting of statutory administrative returns and data derived as a by-product of general administration; and (b) Other important sources namely, censuses and sample surveys.

☐ **Constitutional provisions relating to statistics:**

-subject Statistics" is covered under the following entries in the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India: Entry 94 of the Union List (List-I) and Entry 45 of Concurrent List (List-III) [e.g. Entry-69 (Census) in the Union List, Entry-20 (Economic and social planning) and Entry-30 (Vital statistics including registration of births and deaths) in the Concurrent List.]

-subject statistics" is not covered under the State List (List-II), which means that 'statistics" on all matters in the State List fall under the Concurrent jurisdiction of the Centre and the States.

☐ **Related laws:**

- The Census Act, 1948
- The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 (RBD Act)
- The Collection of Statistics Act, 1953 (4) The Jammu and Kashmir Collection of Statistics Act, 1961
- The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 (came into force on 11th June 2010) which repeals the Collection of Statistics Act, 1953
- The Collection of Statistics Rules, 2011
- Government Resolution on Governing Council for NSSO (Its powers and functions have been given to the NSC now.)

☐ **Indian Statistical Service**

The Indian Statistical Service (ISS) was constituted as a Group A Central Service on 1 November 1961 by pooling together statistical posts offered voluntarily by different ministries and departments of Government of India and en-cadring them. The service was created with the laudable objective of unification of all statistical work, and providing its officers good opportunities of career advancement. But it was born with a congenital defect – a bottom-heavy structure, with very few positions at the top to match career aspirations – as only low-level positions were initially offered for en-cadrement.

Recruitment to the ISS and its sister Indian Economic Service (IES) is made on all-India basis through the ISS/IES Examination conducted by the Union Public Service Commission every year.

-The first examination for direct recruitment to the service was held in the year 1967 and the first batch of the service was appointed in the year 1968.

-MoSPI acts as cadre controlling authority of ISS.

☐ **Training Division**

-National Statistical Systems Training Academy (NSSTA) located at Greater Noida along with the Training Unit located at Pushpa Bhawan, Madangir Road, New Delhi functions as the Training Division of the Central Statistics Office (Social Statistics).

-NSSTA, earlier known as the National Academy of Statistical Administration (NASA), came into existence on 13th February 2009, as a premier Institute primarily fostering human resource development in official statistics at national and state level.

☐ **National Sample Survey Organisation**

The National Sample Survey (**NSS**), initiated in the year 1950, is a nation-wide, large-scale, continuous survey operation conducted in the form of successive rounds. It was established on the basis of a proposal from Professor P.C. Mahalanobis to fill up data gaps for socio-economic planning and policy-making through sample surveys. The NSS is carried out in the form of successive rounds. The NSS is the largest repetitive survey operation in the world. It provides important data on various socio-economic characteristics, to meet the needs of planners, policy makers, researchers and other users. -Almost from its inception, for most of its sample surveys the NSS has been using a standard sampling design: inter-penetrating, multi-stage, stratified, probability-proportional-to-size, circular systematic. There is no system of carrying out methodological studies for assessing the suitability of the sampling design and bringing about improvements. Though circular systematic sampling was an excellent innovation in the early fifties, the method has serious disadvantages. Although it allows estimation of the sampling error through inter-penetrating sub-samples, it has no way of relating the error to the sample size.

☐ **General Survey Solutions (GSS)**

e-SIGMA, (e-Survey Instrument and Generalised Multimodal Application) :The primary aim of e-SIGMA is to convert the entire data collection endeavor from its current Paper-schedule mode to Computer Assisted Personal Interview (CAPI) mode with in-built data validation to enable a faster processing and dissemination of quality data through a synchronized setup integrating the functions of four divisions of NSO – SDRD, DQAD, FOD and SCD. e-SIGMA is multimodal in the sense that it has the inbuilt capacity and flexibility to incorporate different modes of survey like CAPI, Computer Assisted Telephone Interview (CATI), and Computer Assisted Web Interview (CAWI).

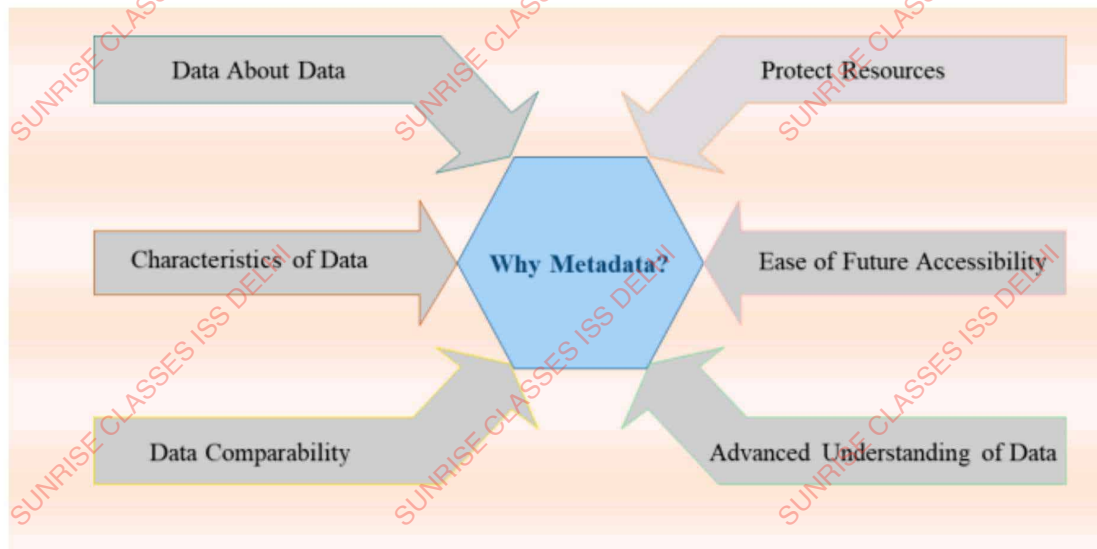
- ☐ **National Metadata Structure (NMDS)** is to provide guidelines for the data producer to adhere to a basic minimum quality standard in order to establish and maintain the quality of data and enhance ease in sharing data.

What is Metadata?

Metadata should contain all the information users need to analyse a dataset and draw conclusions. It increases data accessibility by summarizing the most important information (i.e. methodology, sampling design, interview mode, etc.) required for analyzing a dataset which alleviates the need for users to search for supporting documents and reports. Furthermore, good metadata clearly articulates the potential uses for a dataset, preventing potential misuses.

Why Metadata?

In most information technology usages, the prefix of meta conveys “an underlying definition or description.” So it is that, at its most basic, **metadata is data about data**. More precisely, however, metadata describes data containing specific information like type, length, textual description and other characteristics. **Metadata makes it much easier to find relevant data and to use a dataset, users need to understand how the data is structured, definitions of terms used, how it was collected, and how it should be read.**



In today's modern data driven world and in the era of digital transactions, huge amount of data is generated on real time basis, and lately, a large number of organisations/agencies have started producing data, the quantum of which is huge, and thus arises a need of standard regulatory framework to be laid down to assure the quality of data produced by different producers. It will also serve the purpose of ensuring data comparability across time horizons so as to enable better understanding of different social and economic movements.

Role of MoSPI in Building Metadata Structure

MoSPI being a nodal agency for planned development of the statistical system in the country is also responsible for maintaining the highest standards of data quality which adhere to basic guidelines of International Agencies so as to ensure India's statistical system is one of the frontrunners in quality data producer. MoSPI aims at raising the National Statistical System (NSS) to the epitome of being one of the best professionally equipped government data producing agencies by building the best of IT infrastructure among others in the system, and Metadata is one of the building blocks to achieve the objective.

QuickShot:

1. The main sources of data in the Services Sector are (a) the Follow-up Enterprise Surveys of Economic Census conducted by the MoS&PI, (b) Department of Company Affairs (DCA), and (c) Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
2. The first meeting of the COCSSO was held in September 1971.
3. Delhi Group is an International Expert Group on Informal Sector Statistics.
4. DIID (erstwhile Computer Center): Computer Center was set up in 1967 under the then Department of Statistics in the Cabinet Secretariat with 3 Honey-well-400 Computer Systems to meet the data processing needs of various Government Ministries/Departments/Organizations and Public Sector Undertakings located in and around Delhi. The Honeywell-400 Systems were replaced in 1981 by a more powerful third generation Burroughs-3845 mainframe Computer System. After about a decade, the Burroughs-3845 Computer System was replaced in May, 1992 by a 4th generation mainframe Computer System DPS 7000/240. The Center has now a sophisticated PC-based computer system under Client/Server Architecture using WINDOWS 2008 as the operating system and ORACLE 10g as RDBMS along with software tools Visual Studio 2008, SPSS 17 & STATA/MP 12. Now, the Center is equipped with servers- HP server, HCL server, Sun Micro systems web server and IBM Server.
5. Professor P.C. Mahalanobis, who is regarded as a pioneer in both theoretical and professional statistics, was appointed as the first statistical adviser to the Cabinet, Government of India in January 1949. He was the architect of the statistical system of independent India. Professor P. V. Sukhatme, as Statistical Adviser to the Ministry of Agriculture, was responsible for the development of Agricultural Statistics.

